

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Hospice Landscape

A National Review of Hospice Ownership Models Over Time

BACKGROUND

The composition of the U.S. hospice system has shifted substantially since 2018, driven by rapid expansion of for-profit ownership and growing private equity investment. This report maps that transformation, illustrating how ownership models have shifted from 2018 to 2025, including the increasing involvement of private equity (PE) investments.

The analysis provides an overview of the current hospice landscape, including where hospices are most concentrated, what the ownership models look like, and if they are receiving PE funding. Beyond a current landscape assessment, this report shows how that landscape differs from the 2018 baseline.

KEY FINDINGS

This analysis fills a critical gap in current, publicly available data on the hospice market, examining the landscape in three main ways—the national footprint, shifts in ownership models, and the growing role of private equity.

THE NATIONAL LANDSCAPE

+46%

growth in 8 years

The U.S. hospice market expanded substantially between 2018 and 2025, growing from 4,744 to 6,921 Medicare-certified hospices, a 45.9% increase in just eight years.

Growth has accelerated sharply in recent years, but that expansion has not been evenly distributed across the country. Nevada, California and Arizona led growth with increases of 251%, 128%, and 83%, respectively, while 12 states saw their hospice markets contract.

THE SHIFT TO FOR-PROFIT OWNERSHIP

>50%

*growth in for-profit
hospices*

For-profit hospices drove a large portion of the market's expansion, growing by 51.1% to reach 4,747 hospices by 2025. Over the same period, nonprofit/government-operated hospices declined by 22.2%.

The hospice landscape is now primarily for-profit, and the gap is widening. This continued contraction of the nonprofit and government segment may have implications for the diversity of providers patients can choose from.

THE ROLE OF PRIVATE EQUITY IN HOSPICE

>38%

*of for-profit hospices
with documented
ownership changes
were PE-associated*

Among for-profit hospices with documented change of ownership (CHOW) transactions, more than 1 in 3 (38.7%) were associated with private equity funding.¹

This figure is likely a conservative estimate of the true role that PE plays in the hospice market. Under current regulations, Medicare enrollment records do not require PE disclosure, and many ownership transfers occur through stock sales that bypass formal reporting requirements, full attribution is not possible with available public data. However, what is visible is striking: PE-backed ownership is a substantial and likely undercounted feature of the for-profit hospice market.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Taken together, these findings point to increasing consolidation around larger, for-profit, and in many cases PE-backed, hospices, as the nonprofit and government segment continues to contract. Linking these ownership shifts to patient-level data on care utilization, quality, outcomes, and costs is the critical next step to know how the rapidly changing hospice landscape is affecting the patients and families at the center of it.

For more information on this analysis, including an in-depth methodology, state-specific insights, and the broader implications, see the full report.

¹ This analysis combines publicly available data from CMS and proprietary data from [PitchBook](#), a Morningstar company. Healthsperien conducted this analysis using accepted best practices. The cited data has not been reviewed by PitchBook analysts and may be inconsistent with PitchBook methodology. Please see full report and methodology for more details.